

Laboratory safety checklist

Cells and Scientific Enquiry

Inkwell

Read this before every practical session. Tick each line as you check it.

Before you start

- ☐ Read the method and the hazard notes
- ☐ Tie back long hair and loose clothing
- ☐ Wear safety glasses when told to
- ☐ Know where the eye wash and fire blanket are
- ☐ Keep bags off the bench and the floor clear
- ☐ Check glassware for cracks

During the practical

- ☐ Never eat or drink in the laboratory
- ☐ Point test tubes away from people when heating
- ☐ Use the correct volumes; never taste or sniff directly
- ☐ Report spills and breakages immediately
- ☐ Stay at your station with your equipment

After you finish

- ☐ Turn off gas, water and electrical equipment
- ☐ Dispose of waste in the correct containers
- ☐ Clean and dry your bench
- ☐ Wash your hands with soap

Hazard symbols to recognise

Symbol	Meaning
Flame	Flammable
Corrosion	Damages skin and metals
Exclamation mark	Irritant or harmful
Skull and crossbones	Toxic

In an emergency

Tell your teacher at once. For chemicals in the eye, rinse with running water for at least ten minutes.